

Custom app — setup

Create the Shopify custom app that gives the Advent Calendar scripts (`npm run setup` and the individual `npm run ...` commands) an Admin API token. One app, one token, ~5 minutes. Do this **before** running the setup.

1 • Enable custom app development (one time, store owner)

1. **Settings** → **Apps and sales channels** → **Develop apps**.
2. If prompted, click **Allow custom app development** and confirm. (Only the store owner / a user with the permission can do this; it's a one-time switch for the whole store.)

2 • Create the app

1. **Create an app**.
2. Name it something recognisable, e.g. `Advent Calendar setup`. App developer can be left as you. **Create app**.

3 • Select the Admin API scopes

1. On the app, open **Configuration** → under **Admin API integration** click **Configure** (or **Edit**).
2. Tick exactly these **Admin API access scopes**:

Scope	Needed for
<code>read_metaobjects</code>	reading definitions/entries back
<code>write_metaobjects</code>	creating the 25 day entries + the parent
<code>write_metaobject_definitions</code>	creating the two metaobject definitions
<code>read_themes</code>	<code>list-themes</code> , checking the target theme
<code>write_themes</code>	uploading the section/snippets/assets + template
<code>write_content</code>	creating the storefront page

3. **Save**.

If you only want the metaobjects + entries (not the theme/page scripts), the last three scopes (`read_themes`, `write_themes`, `write_content`) are optional.

4 • Install the app

1. Top right → **Install app** → **Install**.
2. Installing is what generates the Admin API access token.

5 · Copy the Admin API access token

1. Open the **API credentials** tab.
2. Under **Admin API access token**, click **Reveal token once** and copy the value — it starts with `shpat_`. It is shown **only once**; if you lose it, uninstall the app and install it again to get a new one.

The **API key** and **API secret key** also on that page are *not* what these scripts use — they use the **access token** (`shpat_...`).

6 · Put the credentials in `scripts/.env`

From `shopify-advent-calendar/` :

```
cp scripts/.env.example scripts/.env
```

Then edit `scripts/.env` :

```
SHOPIFY_STORE=your-store.myshopify.com      (host only - no https://, no trailing /)
SHOPIFY_ADMIN_TOKEN=shpat_XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
```

`scripts/.env` is git-ignored. Never commit it or paste the token anywhere shared. To rotate the token: uninstall the app, install again, update `.env` .

7 · Run the setup

```
cd shopify-advent-calendar
npm run setup
```

The wizard reads `scripts/.env` , asks for the theme id / page title / grid, then creates the definitions, the 25 entries, the theme files + template, and the page — with an optional final step to publish the theme. Everything is idempotent, so a failed run can just be re-run.

Prefer to run the pieces yourself? `npm run create-defs` , `npm run seed` , `npm run list-themes` , `npm run push-theme -- <theme-id>` , `npm run create-page` . See `INTEGRATION.md` §6.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Fix
"Develop apps" missing or greyed out	The store owner must do step 1 (Allow custom app development). Staff need the app-development permission.
Script prints an auth error / <code>401</code>	Wrong token, token belongs to another store, or <code>SHOPIFY_STORE</code> is wrong (must be the <code>*.myshopify.com</code> host).
Error mentions a field / "access denied" for a resource	A scope is missing. Add it in Configuration , Save , then update / reinstall the app — new scopes don't apply until the install is updated.

Symptom	Fix
Lost the token	Uninstall the app, install again, copy the new token, update <code>.env</code> .

Advent Calendar for Shopify · custom-app setup. Full reference: [shopify-advent-calendar/docs/INTEGRATION.md](#)
\$6 / \$6.1.